Southern California Association of Governments
October 26, 2026

MINUTES OF THE MEETING
REGIONAL HOUSING NEEDS ASSESSMENT SUBCOMMITTEE
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 10, 2026

THE FOLLOWING MINUTES ARE A SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN BY THE REGIONAL HOUSING NEEDS ASSESSMENT SUBCOMMITTEE. A VIDEO RECORDING OF THE ACTUAL MEETING IS AVAILABLE ON THE SCAG WEBSITE AT: http://scag.iqm2.com/Citizens/.

The Regional Housing Needs Assessment Subcommittee (RHNA) of the Southern California Association of Governments (SCAG) held its meeting virtually (telephonically and electronically). A quorum was present.

MEMBERS PRESENT

Hon. Rocky Rhodes (Chair)	**Ventura County Representative**
Hon. Debbie Baker	Orange County Representative
Hon. Chelsea Byers	Los Angeles County Representative
Hon. Tanya Doby	Orange County Representative
Hon. Margaret Finlay	Los Angeles County Representative
Hon. John Gabbard	Orange County Representative
Hon. Gary Gardner	Riverside County Representative
Hon. Mike Goodsell	Imperial County Representative
Sup. Vianey Lopez	Ventura County Representative
Hon. Steve Manos	Riverside County Representative
Hon. David Shapiro	Los Angeles County Reprsentative
Hon. Helen Tran	San Bernardino County Representative
Hon. Acquanetta Warren	San Bernardino County Representative

MEMBERS NOT PRESENT

Hon. Cindy Allen	Los Angeles County Representative
Hon. Patricia Lock Dawson	Riverside County Representative
Sup. Curt Hagman	San Bernardino County Representative
Hon. Gil Rebollar	Imperial County Representative

STAFF PRESENT

Elizabeth Carvajal, Deputy Director of Land Use
Ma'Ayn Johnson, Department Manager of Housing
Jeffery Elder, Chief Counsel

Richard Lam, Senior Deputy Legal Counsel
Maggie Aguilar, Clerk of the Board

CALL TO ORDER AND PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Chair Rhodes called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m. and asked Regional Council Member Tanya Doby, Orange County Representative, to lead the Pledge of Allegiance.

PUBLIC COMMENT PERIOD

Chair Rhodes opened the Public Comment Period for persons to comment on any matter pertinent to SCAG's jurisdiction that were not listed on the agenda.

The Clerk of the Board acknowledged there was one written public comment received before the deadline, which was posted on the website and transmitted to members.

Seeing no public comment speakers, Chair Rhodes closed the Public Comment Period.

REVIEW AND PRIORITIZE AGENDA ITEMS

There were no requests to prioritize agenda items.

CONSENT CALENDAR

There were no public comments on the Consent Calendar.

Approval Items

1. Minutes of the Meeting – August 13, 2026

Receive and File

2. RHNA Subcommittee Topic Outlook

A MOTION was made (Finlay) to approve Consent Calendar Item No. 1; and Receive and File Item No. 2. Motion was SECONDED (Manos). The motion passed by the following roll call votes:

AYES: Baker, Byers, Doby, Finlay, Gabbard, Gardner, Goodsell, Lopez, Manos, Rhodes, and Tran (11)

NOES: None (0)

ABSTAINS: None (0)

ACTION ITEM

3. Election of Vice Chair – Verbal Report

There were no public comments for Item 3.

Richard Lam, Senior Deputy Legal Counsel, reported that two nominations for the RHNA Subcommittee Vice Chair had been received: Honorable John Gabbard of the City of Dana Point and Honorable Chelsea Byers of the City of West Hollywood. He outlined the nomination and election procedures, noting that additional nominations could be made from the floor, nominations did not require a second, self-nominations were permitted, and nominees could decline candidacy. He further explained that candidates would be given up to three minutes to address the subcommittee before the Clerk conducted the vote for Vice Chair.

Chair Rhodes open the floor for nominations. Seeing none, he closed the floor for nominations and proceeded to ask Regional Council Member Byers to provide her candidate statement, followed by Regional Council Member Gabbard.

Regional Council Member Chelsea Byers expressed she was honored for the opportunity to stand before the Subcommittee as a nominee for the Vice Chair role. She highlighted her experience in meeting facilitation and leadership roles, including serving as mayor and chairing regional committees, and emphasized her commitment to supporting the Chair, advancing the subcommittee's work, encouraging public engagement, and increasing community awareness of the RHNA process. She concluded by expressing appreciation for the opportunity and recognizing the qualifications of the other nominee.

Regional Council Member John Gabbard thanked the subcommittee and fellow nominee Chelsea Byers and highlighted his extensive leadership experience on regional boards and more than 40 years of experience in housing and construction. He noted his familiarity with housing issues throughout Southern California, referenced his service as Chair and Past Chair of the Orange County Council of Governments (OCCOG), and emphasized his experience facilitating meetings and advancing committee work efficiently. He concluded by expressing appreciation for the members' consideration and support.

Chair Rhodes thanked both candidates for their remarks and opened the election for RHNA Subcommittee Vice Chair. He instructed members to state their selected candidate's name when called upon and advised that the Clerk would tabulate the votes and announce the election results.

Regional Council Member John Gabbard, Orange County Representative was selected as Vice Chair of the RHNA Subcommittee by the following roll call votes:

Byers: Byers, Finlay, Gardner, Lopez, and Tran (5)

Gabbard: Baker, Doby, Gabbard, Goodsell, Manos, Rhodes, and Shapiro (7)

The Clerked noted that Regional Council Member Cindy Allen raised her hand to provide comment. The Clerk noted that Member Allen was not at a noticed location but if she wanted, she could provide public comment.

Regional Council Member Allen thanked both candidates for their willingness to serve as Vice Chair and acknowledged the importance of stepping forward for leadership responsibilities. She expressed support for whoever was elected and conveyed appreciation for their commitment to the RHNA Subcommittee.

4. 7th Cycle RHNA Survey Packet

Chair Rhodes reported that action on this item would be approval for staff to distribute the survey packet. He explained that as they begin developing the 7th Cycle RHNA methodology, this survey packet, which includes two separate surveys, was intended to help gather input from SCAG jurisdictions on key priorities and considerations. He noted that feedback received would help inform future discussions and support the development of the RHNA methodology.

Ma'Ayn Johnson, Housing Department Manager, presented an action item recommending approval to distribute the Local Planning Factor Survey and the Affirmatively Furthering Fair Housing (AFFH) Survey, both required under state law to support development of the RHNA methodology. She explained that the surveys would collect information from jurisdictions on local planning factors, housing needs, fair housing considerations, climate risks, homelessness, and related planning issues. Ms. Johnson noted that survey responses would help identify regional trends and inform the proposed RHNA methodology, with distribution planned for the following week, responses due by January 29, 2027, and results to be published and considered as staff developed recommendations for the subcommittee's review in March 2027.

Chair Rhodes opened the public comment period.

Jim Light inquired which city officials or departments would receive the RHNA surveys to help ensure community participation and follow-up. He also asked whether there would be an opportunity to provide input on the survey content or whether the survey questions had already been finalized.

Chair Rhodes thanked the speaker for his comments and, in the interest of time, indicated that questions would be addressed offline. He advised that the surveys would be distributed through city clerks and noted that the subcommittee's action on the item would determine approval of the survey content for distribution.

Ms. Johnson clarified that the surveys would be distributed to housing managers, community development directors, and planning managers at jurisdictions, as applicable. She stated that staff would coordinate with jurisdictions to ensure that only one survey response was submitted per jurisdiction. Ms. Johnson further noted that the RHNA Subcommittee was continuing to develop methodology components and that survey feedback received through March would be considered in the development of the proposed RHNA methodology.

Chair Rhodes clarified that the question pertained to whether the survey had already been finalized for distribution and whether there would be an opportunity to provide input on its content.

Ms. Johnson clarified that the proposed survey had been included in the agenda packet and made available online but had not yet been finalized. She stated that the RHNA Subcommittee could consider modifications or additions to the survey prior to taking action.

Chair Rhodes closed the public comment period.

Regional Council Member Vianey Lopez, Ventura County Representative, expressed concern that the survey questions may be subjective and requested additional clarification on their intent and how responses will ultimately influence RHNA allocation numbers.

Ms. Johnson explained that survey responses would be reviewed and incorporated into the development of a proposed regional methodology, though the specific methodology had not yet been created. She noted that survey results and findings would be shared publicly and referenced the sixth-cycle methodology as an example.

Regional Council Member Lopez asked whether jurisdictions would have an opportunity to provide further clarification or participate in a follow-up survey after responses were reviewed.

Ms. Johnson stated that staff could contact jurisdictions directly for clarification when needed but indicated that timing constraints made an additional survey unlikely.

Regional Council Member Tanya Doby, Orange County Representative, proposed adding first responder service capacity as a planning factor and requested explicit consideration of federal and state military base lands in the survey to avoid allocation issues experienced during the previous cycle.

Ms. Johnson responded that such additions could be made at the subcommittee's discretion and noted that she believed federal bases were already contemplated under existing factors.

Chair Rhodes sought clarification on whether fire or emergency services were already addressed in the survey factors.

Ms. Johnson clarified that emergency evacuation capacity was included as a factor, but emergency service capacity was not.

Mr. Lam advised that Regional Council Member Doby could make a motion to amend the survey recommendations if desired.

Regional Council Member Doby indicated her intent to pursue amendments addressing first responder service capacity and military base lands, distinguishing emergency services from evacuation capacity.

Chair Rhodes invited additional comments before considering amendments.

Regional Council Member Gabbard indicated he supported Regional Council Member Lopez's concerns regarding survey responses and suggested requiring city manager approval to ensure accountability and accuracy.

Ms. Johnson stated that staff could explore ways to include city manager acknowledgement or authorization within the online survey process.

Regional Council Member Gabbard emphasized that city manager approval would help prevent jurisdictions from later disputing survey responses based on staff error or misunderstanding.

Chair Rhodes noted that some jurisdictions may not have city managers and questioned how the requirement would apply.

Ms. Johnson suggested using "city manager or designee" language to address varying governmental structures.

Chair Rhodes acknowledged the suggested modification.

Regional Council Member Gabbard noted that county CEOs could serve a similar approving role for county jurisdictions.

Regional Council Member Margaret Finlay, Los Angeles County Representative, asked whether city councils were typically informed of or reviewed survey responses and suggested that broader awareness could be beneficial.

Ms. Johnson explained that there was no current requirement for city council review and noted that time constraints could limit such involvement.

Regional Council Member Acquanetta Warren, San Bernardino Representative, suggested incorporating an acknowledgement mechanism to ensure city councils were informed while recognizing the challenges that formal council approval could create.

Regional Council Member Byers requested clarification regarding proposed amendments related to emergency services and whether they would expand upon existing survey language concerning evacuation routes and climate-related impacts.

Regional Council Member Doby clarified that her proposal focused specifically on first responder service capacity and the ability of police and fire services to accommodate future growth.

Regional Council Member Byers asked whether the proposed amendment would specifically address the capacity of existing first responder services as a planning factor.

Regional Council Member Doby responded that both current capacity and the ability to expand services should be considered.

Regional Council Member Byers expressed concern that expanding the survey to include service capacity could broaden its scope significantly and asked staff to comment on potential limitations and implications.

Ms. Johnson noted that state law allows consideration of additional factors necessary to address significant health and safety conditions, provided they are properly justified and applied consistently.

Regional Council Member Lopez asked whether survey results would be brought back to the subcommittee for review before being incorporated into the methodology.

Ms. Johnson explained that a review meeting could be scheduled if survey deadlines were adjusted, though doing so would require changes to the project timeline.

Regional Council Member Lopez expressed support for reviewing survey results to promote transparency and careful interpretation of responses.

Elizabeth Carvajal, Deputy Director of Land Use, sought clarification on whether adjusting the schedule would require reducing the response period available to cities and counties.

Ms. Johnson confirmed that shortening the response timeframe would be necessary to accommodate a February review meeting.

Regional Council Member Lopez asked whether the survey could be distributed as early as the following week.

Ms. Johnson confirmed that an earlier distribution was possible.

Ms. Carvajal explained that staff would need sufficient time to process responses and prepare materials, requiring an earlier survey deadline if a February briefing were scheduled.

Chair Rhodes summarized his understanding that jurisdictions' responses could be compiled and shared, though there might not otherwise be sufficient time for Subcommittee feedback before methodology development.

Ms. Carvajal clarified that staff could provide survey results to the subcommittee before methodology development if timelines were adjusted accordingly.

Chair Rhodes stated that the proposed timeline adjustment appeared reasonable.

Regional Council Member Gary Gardner, Riverside County Representative, expressed concern about reducing the response period for cities, supported reviewing survey results, and asked whether disputes over survey submissions had been a problem in prior RHNA cycles.

Ms. Carvajal suggested maintaining the January 29 deadline while potentially adjusting future meeting dates to provide time for staff review and subcommittee consideration of survey results.

Regional Council Member Finlay emphasized the importance of ensuring city councils were informed of survey submissions to avoid future misunderstandings and communication issues.

Regional Council Member Gardner agreed that stronger local review procedures should be considered and suggested either city manager certification or formal city council approval.

Chair Rhodes noted that requiring council approval could increase the burden on cities and exceed statutory requirements, though it may offer political benefits.

Ms. Johnson reminded the Subcommittee that the survey had to be issued within the statutory six-month period preceding release of the proposed methodology, limiting scheduling flexibility.

Regional Council Member Steve Manos, Riverside County Representative, opposed adding first responder service capacity to the survey, arguing that cities were responsible for addressing service impacts through local planning. He supported releasing the survey promptly, cautioned against requiring council approval, suggested notifying elected officials directly, and supported providing survey results for subcommittee review.

Regional Council Member Gabbard expressed concern over requiring council approval due to timing concerns but supported executive-level review, as well as a February review of survey responses to improve transparency and regional understanding.

Mr. Lam asked whether Regional Council Member Doby's amendment regarding survey modifications remained under consideration.

Regional Council Member Doby withdrew her proposed amendment concerning first responder service capacity but maintained her request to explicitly identify military base lands within the survey.

Mr. Lam requested clarification regarding a proposed friendly amendment from Vice Chair Gabbard.

Regional Council Member Gabbard proposed requiring approval or acknowledgement of survey responses by each jurisdiction's chief executive officer to enhance accountability and transparency.

Ms. Johnson pointed out that an existing survey factor references lands protected from development under federal or state programs and asked whether that language sufficiently addressed concerns regarding military base lands.

Regional Council Member Doby stated that explicit reference to military base lands remained necessary because previous RHNA allocations had improperly counted such lands.

Ms. Carvajal asked whether an online acknowledgment by a city manager or chief executive would satisfy the proposed approval requirement.

Regional Council Member Gabbard indicated flexibility regarding the approval mechanism, emphasizing only that executive-level authorization be verified.

Chair Rhodes asked whether any clarification regarding survey due dates was needed for the motion.

Ms. Carvajal confirmed that the January 29 survey deadline would remain unchanged.

Regional Council Member Finlay reiterated the importance of informing city councils about the survey process to reduce future confusion and political concerns.

Chair Rhodes suggested that informing city councils should be handled locally rather than through the survey methodology process itself.

Regional Council Member Finlay agreed but recommended encouraging jurisdictions to notify city councils about the survey and its significance.

Chair Rhodes supported including such a recommendation when distributing the survey.

Regional Council Member Lopez requested clarification on whether a future review of survey results by the Subcommittee needed to be included in the motion.

Ms. Carvajal responded that a separate motion was not necessary, as staff had already received direction to reevaluate meeting dates and provide survey results to the Subcommittee before methodology discussions.

Regional Council Member Lopez thanked staff for considering the Subcommittee's concerns and supporting greater transparency in the process.

An amended MOTION was made (Doby) to explicitly identify military base lands within the survey, require approval or acknowledgement of survey responses by each jurisdiction's city manager or chief executive officer to enhance accountability and transparency, and to approve distribution of the 7th Cycle RHNA Survey Packet, inclusive of the Local Planning Factor Survey and the Affirmatively Furthering Fair Housing Survey. The amended motion was SECONDED (Gabbard) and passed by the following roll call votes:

AYES: Baker, Byers, Doby, Finlay, Gabbard, Gardner, Goodsell, Lopez, Manos, Rhodes, Shapiro, Tran, and Warren (13)

NOES: None (0)

ABSTAINS: None (0)

INFORMATION ITEMS

5. Overview of the 6th Cycle RHNA Methodology

Chair Rhodes noted that the previous month they had heard about the RHNA methodology process, which had been one of the Subcommittee's primary responsibilities to develop. He indicated that, due to time constraints, they had heard a brief overview of milestones and the various components that could be considered. He explained that SCAG staff would continue the overview and also provide an overview of the 6th cycle methodology. He emphasized that understanding the components and allocation formula of the 6th cycle methodology could help inform discussion of the various components that they would ultimately recommend for the 7th cycle methodology.

Ma'Ayn Johnson, Department Manager of Housing, provided an overview of the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology to inform future discussions regarding development of the seventh-cycle methodology. She reviewed the statutory requirements governing RHNA, including housing objectives, planning factors, and consistency with Connect SoCal. Ms. Johnson explained that the sixth-cycle methodology allocated housing need based on a combination of projected housing need and existing housing need, with existing need determined through factors such as job accessibility, transit accessibility, and regional equity considerations. She further described how social equity adjustments had been applied to promote fair housing objectives, avoid the overconcentration of lower-income households, and distribute housing need across income categories. She noted that staff had continued to work with the California Department of Housing and Community Development on the regional determination and had remained on schedule to present a proposed seventh-cycle methodology to the Subcommittee in March 2027.

Jim Light commented that the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology had resulted in inequitable housing allocations for certain jurisdictions. He cited the City of Redondo Beach as an example, noting that factors such as job accessibility and transit proximity did not fully reflect local conditions, including transit usage, jobs-to-housing balance, and limited opportunities for commercial-to-residential conversion. He expressed concern that the allocation had contributed to the displacement of jobs and increased commuting and encouraged consideration of these issues during development of the seventh-cycle RHNA methodology.

Regional Council Member Gabbard questioned whether the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology may have disproportionately allocated housing need to communities with high access to jobs and transit, including potentially disadvantaged areas. He acknowledged that the methodology had included

adjustments to reduce overconcentration in disadvantaged communities but emphasized the importance of carefully evaluating future methodology factors to avoid overburdening jurisdictions based solely on their proximity to jobs and transit. He urged the Subcommittee to keep these concerns in mind during development of the seventh-cycle methodology.

Chair Rhodes concurred that lessons learned from the previous RHNA cycle should inform development of the next methodology and emphasized the Subcommittee's role in evaluating past outcomes and new statutory requirements as part of that process.

There were no public comments for Item 5.

6. 7th Cycle RHNA Methodology Brainstorm: Social Equity Considerations

Chair Rhodes stated that as they began exploring potential components of the methodology, this discussion provided an opportunity to begin considering how equity-related objectives and outcomes might be incorporated into the allocation process. He noted that the presentation was intended as an initial brainstorming conversation and an opportunity for members to share perspectives before methodology development progressed further.

Ma'Ayn Johnson, Department Manager of Housing, presented an overview of how social equity was incorporated into the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology and outlined potential approaches for consideration in developing the seventh-cycle methodology. She explained that the prior methodology used social equity adjustments to further state housing objectives, including affirmatively furthering fair housing and reducing the overconcentration of lower-income households in disadvantaged communities. Ms. Johnson described how factors such as job access, transit access, disadvantaged community status, and opportunity indicators informed RHNA allocations and income-category distributions. She also reviewed relevant Connect SoCal social equity policies and presented several potential framework options for the next RHNA cycle, including refining the existing methodology, expanding fair housing considerations, emphasizing anti-displacement strategies, simplifying the social equity framework, or pursuing an alternative approach. She emphasized that the presentation was intended to provide background and solicit Subcommittee feedback to inform staff's development of a proposed seventh-cycle RHNA methodology.

Mr. Light commented that the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology created a cycle in which higher-cost coastal communities received increasingly larger affordable housing allocations due to existing housing market conditions. He argued that because local jurisdictions had limited ability to require affordable housing at levels exceeding state requirements, new development often resulted in a greater proportion of market-rate units than affordable units. Mr. Light expressed concern that this dynamic could perpetuate higher future housing allocations without substantially increasing

affordable housing production and suggested that the methodology may not have effectively achieved its intended equity objectives in high land-value communities.

Marle Chen, California State Council on Developmental Disabilities, highlighted the importance of increasing housing accessibility for individuals with disabilities, including persons receiving regional center services and older adults. She noted ongoing collaboration with HCD and emphasized the need to incorporate the housing needs of people with disabilities into RHNA-related discussions. Ms. Chen expressed support for expanding affordable and accessible housing opportunities for underserved populations, offered the Council as a resource to the Subcommittee, and encouraged continued collaboration with SCAG on accessible housing, transportation accessibility, and mobility issues affecting individuals with disabilities.

Jake Pierce, a resident of Los Angeles, expressed support for expanding the social equity framework and encouraged consideration of the option that would incorporate a broader range of opportunity-based factors into the RHNA methodology. He suggested that factors such as access to education, health outcomes, and climate resilience could help promote equitable housing opportunities and improve access to resources throughout the region. Mr. Pierce acknowledged the benefits of simplifying the methodology but recommended doing so without reducing consideration of key equity factors. He also expressed concerns regarding approaches that would focus primarily on anti-displacement measures or require a complete redesign of the methodology, stating that such options could either fall outside the RHNA framework or unnecessarily complicate the process.

Regional Council Member Doby thanked staff for the presentations and encouraged consideration of additional demographic and socioeconomic factors in future RHNA methodology discussions. She highlighted the growing senior population in many communities and noted that increasing home values might not accurately reflect the financial circumstances of older residents who chose to age in place. Member Doby expressed concern that existing indicators, such as median home value and poverty measures, might not fully capture local conditions and urged further evaluation of factors affecting senior residents, housing affordability, and community-level economic realities to ensure the methodology reflected current housing challenges.

Regional Council Member Manos questioned whether the social equity adjustments used in the prior RHNA methodology effectively addressed the housing needs of disadvantaged communities. While acknowledging the goal of avoiding concentrations of affordable housing, he expressed concern that redistributing housing need away from disadvantaged areas could limit affordable housing opportunities for residents who needed them most. Member Manos emphasized the importance of providing affordable housing near employment centers, transit, and accessible community amenities, and noted the practical challenges of developing affordable housing in high-cost coastal communities. He also encouraged consideration of housing affordability and rental

costs as part of future methodology discussions and indicated support for expanding opportunity-based factors within the RHNA framework.

Regional Council Member Gardner asked how county-level income categories used in the RHNA methodology accounted for significant economic differences among communities within large and geographically diverse counties. He noted that income conditions could vary substantially between jurisdictions within the same county and questioned how such local variations were reflected when determining low-, very low-, and other income-level allocations. He emphasized that the treatment of income categories was a key component of the RHNA methodology and sought clarification on how these disparities were addressed.

Ms. Johnson explained that state housing law required income categories used in the RHNA methodology to be based on county median income, regardless of variations among communities within a county. She noted that while county median income was a statutory requirement for establishing income levels, other methodology components developed by SCAG, such as the residual need redistribution process, were discretionary and could be modified as part of the Subcommittee's consideration of future RHNA methodology options.

Regional Council Member Gardner suggested that access to healthcare be considered as a factor in evaluating social equity within the RHNA methodology. He noted that residents in his community had to travel significant distances to access healthcare services and that such services could become inaccessible during severe weather events. Member Gardner emphasized that access to healthcare was an important component of community well-being and recommended that healthcare accessibility be considered when evaluating housing allocations and social equity outcomes.

Ms. Johnson responded that access to healthcare was not a factor included in the social equity indicators used for the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology. She stated that staff would review the current California Tax Credit Allocation Committee (TCAC) opportunity indicators to determine whether healthcare access had been incorporated in more recent updates and noted that it had not been part of the factors considered during the previous RHNA cycle.

Regional Council Member Gardner recommended that access to healthcare be considered as a factor in the development of the seventh-cycle RHNA methodology. He requested that staff evaluate healthcare accessibility as part of its ongoing methodology development efforts, noting that it was an important component of community well-being and social equity. He expressed support for including healthcare access among the factors reviewed as staff refined and developed future RHNA methodology options.

Regional Council Member Lopez expressed appreciation for the discussion and feedback provided on the social equity framework. She stated that she had concerns regarding the inclusion of the

residual housing need adjustment within the existing methodology and requested additional information on potential alternatives. Member Lopez also raised questions about the role of high-quality transit areas in the methodology, including how current transit service levels, future transit plans, and input from local transit agencies were considered. She encouraged further discussion regarding how transit accessibility was evaluated and how it might influence future RHNA allocations.

Ms. Johnson explained that the sixth-cycle RHNA methodology relied on the applicable Connect SoCal plan, which incorporated data and forecasting developed through coordination with county transportation commissions and local agencies. She stated that the methodology considered both existing and planned transit investments when evaluating transit accessibility and identifying High-Quality Transit Areas (HQTAs). Ms. Johnson noted that HQTAs were no longer the primary transit planning designation and had since been replaced by other transportation and mobility planning frameworks. She advised that staff would provide a more detailed discussion of transit-related factors and methodologies at a future RHNA Subcommittee meeting focused specifically on transportation considerations.

Regional Council Member Lopez noted that the sixth-cycle methodology relied on projected 2045 transit investments and expressed interest in understanding how those projections compared with current transit capacity and service levels. She suggested that evaluating both planned and existing transit conditions could help inform future RHNA methodology discussions.

Regional Council Member Goodsell stated that his county met many of the characteristics associated with disadvantaged communities and expressed support for Option B as the preferred approach for the seventh-cycle RHNA methodology. He concurred with comments that access to healthcare should be considered as a social equity indicator and noted ongoing local efforts to establish a valley-wide healthcare district. He stated his support for incorporating healthcare access into future methodology discussions.

ADJOURNMENT

Chair Rhodes reported that staff had held their first full consultation meeting with HCD on September 2, which was the first exchange of data and approaches that would inform the RHND. He stated that as had been shared at their first meeting, state law listed the required factors HCD had to consider in its RHND and also outlined that HCD was required to consult with the COG and the California Department of Finance as part of the process. He shared that HCD appeared to have similar data and approaches as SCAG staff had outlined at the August RHNA Subcommittee meeting. He further noted that HCD appeared eager to consider SCAG's recommended approaches. He reported that staff had committed to biweekly meetings until October 15, which was HCD's deadline to issue a determination. He explained that at the first RHNA Subcommittee meeting after

that date, staff would share the RHND and the Subcommittee would decide whether to recommend that the CEHD and RC object to HCD's determination.

Kevin Kane, Supervisor of the Demographics and Growth Vision Program, described the initial consultation with HCD as constructive and stated that staff was cautiously optimistic about the process. He noted that HCD had committed to additional discussions and was considering SCAG's input regarding regional planning assumptions and methodology approaches.

Chair Rhodes thanked the members for their participation. He noted that to ensure they would be able to review and take potential action on the RHND, the October meeting had been rescheduled to Monday, October 26, from 2:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m. He stated that staff would send confirmation to Subcommittee members.

There being no further business, Chair Rhodes adjourned the Regional Housing Needs Assessment Subcommittee meeting at 2:44 p.m.

[MINUTES ARE UNOFFICIAL UNTIL APPROVED BY THE REGIONAL HOUSING NEEDS ASSESSMENT SUBCOMMITTEE]

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